

READING PASSAGE 1

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 1–13**, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.*

New Understanding of Giraffes in the Wild

Even as the tallest animals on Earth, giraffes can be easy to overlook. Despite being a favorite in zoos, until recently almost nobody studied giraffes in the wild. ‘When I first became interested in giraffes in 2008 and started looking through the scientific literature, I was really surprised to see how little had been done,’ said Megan Strauss, an animal researcher at the University of Minnesota, USA. All that is changing fast, as a growing number of researchers seek to understand the biology and complex behavior of this graceful giant in its native habitat.

Giraffes, found throughout sub-Saharan Africa, are currently classified as a single species with up to nine varieties that differ by features like head shape and whether the fur on their legs is plain or patterned. The giraffe is listed as endangered, but researchers point to evidence that in the past 15 years, the population has fallen some 40 percent.

Recent studies have allowed researchers new insights into giraffes’ social structure. Groups of female giraffes, for example, have been found to form close friendships that can last for years. ‘We’re just at the beginnings of trying to understand this kind of behavior,’ Dr Strauss said. Female giraffes can live 20 years or more, and it makes sense they might rely on each other for clues to the best feeding grounds, help with taking care of their young, or the reduction of stress, by staying in groups.

Mother giraffes have displayed signs of grief after losing their young, known as calves, to lions. Dr Strauss described one case in which a mother spent four days at the place where a lion had eaten her calf, refusing food, and often in the company of two other adult females. Giraffe calves are extremely vulnerable to predators, and though mothers will fight valiantly to keep their young alive — kicking forward and backward — half of all calves are killed in their first year of life.

Male giraffes, known as bulls, generally become more important with age, and older bulls display that dominance physically and behaviorally: as their neck muscles grow, the male’s posture becomes prouder and more vertical. Recent observations show young bulls, when left on their own, mimicking their elders: head held high and neck puffed out. But should a dominant older bull come into view, the younger males instantly try to make themselves look small and innocent.

The younger bulls have reason to fear their elders. Clashes have been witnessed between adults when each bull repeatedly ‘necks’ the other, using his massive neck to slam his head against his rival. One bull somehow survived with a broken neck.

The skin of a giraffe is mostly gray. The coat has dark patches separated by light hair, which serves as camouflage, allowing them to blend in with the light and shade patterns of the acacia trees from which they feed. Grazing giraffes are hard to see even a few meters away.

Research indicates that giraffes also have excellent sight, can see in color and over great distances, which helps them to spot lions and keep track of each other. In addition, a giraffe's extraordinary mouth has lips and tongue that can together grasp a branch and then pluck away the leaves while avoiding thorns, almost as humans would grab with their hands. Each day, a giraffe consumes about 30 kilograms of leaves, shoots and vines, all digested in its four-chambered stomach.

A giraffe can stand more than six meters tall, with its neck accounting for roughly a third of its height and its legs the same. The giraffe's long neck is due to the length of the vertebrae, not the number of vertebrae. The growth of the neck largely takes place during early childhood, as giraffe mothers would have a difficult time giving birth to young with longer necks. The giraffe's head and neck are held up by large muscles attached to the lower spine.

Recent studies show that the greatest challenge to a giraffe's cardiovascular system is how to both pump blood very high and retrieve it from far below. The outside of a giraffe's veins are extremely thick, to prevent blood leaking into surrounding tissue. Other adaptations in the cardiovascular system allow the giraffe to bend over for a drink of water, and then raise its head again quickly without fainting.

Researchers were also surprised to find that a giraffe does not have an unusually large heart. It is half a percent of body mass, the same as in a mouse. Moreover, the amount of blood pumped into circulation is modest, proportionally lower than it is in humans. That could help explain why giraffes rarely run for very long: enough oxygen cannot be delivered to their muscles fast enough for them to keep running. Or maybe the giraffes are worried about tripping over their own feet. This is because signals from the nerves travel at about the same speed in giraffes as in rats or other mammals. Given the greater distance they have to travel in the giraffe to reach the brain, it is possible the giraffe faces real challenges in reacting quickly to a rock beneath its hoof or a bite to its ankle.

New understanding of this wonderful animal sheds light on both its physiology and its behavior. Researchers hope to use this knowledge to increase their ability to work with preservation, as its habitat is reduced and the giraffe becomes scarcer.

Questions 1–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 1–7 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE	<i>if the statement agrees with the information</i>
FALSE	<i>if the statement contradicts the information</i>
NOT GIVEN	<i>if there is no information on this</i>

- 1 The amount of research on giraffes in their natural environment has increased lately.
- 2 Megan Strauss disapproves of keeping giraffes in zoos.
- 3 The number of giraffes in Africa has nearly doubled.
- 4 Female giraffes tend to live longer than males.
- 5 Mother giraffes sometimes use their legs to defend their young.
- 6 Younger bulls hold their necks higher in the presence of more powerful males.
- 7 Male giraffes have been observed fighting.

Questions 8–13

Complete the table below.

Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes 8-13 on your answer sheet.

Giraffes: body structure	
Physical features	Study findings
Skin/coat	• provides 8 _____ when standing near trees
Eyes	• allow them to look out for lions
Mouth	• can be used like 9 _____ to get leaves
Neck	• about equal in length to the legs • length develops in childhood to provide an easier 10 _____ for mothers
Cardiovascular system	• extra-strong 11 _____ keep blood from spilling into other tissues
12 _____	• normal size for such a large animal
Nerves	• slower reaction time because 13 _____ need to go farther to the brain

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Questions 1–7 判断题

题号	答案	题干翻译	详细定位句	定位句翻译	详细解释
1	TRUE	关于野生环境中长颈鹿的研究数量，近来增加了。	第1段：“Despite being a favorite in zoos, until recently almost nobody studied giraffes in the wild.” / “All that is changing fast, as a growing number of researchers seek to understand the biology and complex behavior of this graceful giant in its native habitat.”	“尽管长颈鹿在动物园里很受欢迎，但直到最近，几乎没有人研究野外的长颈鹿。” / “这一切正在迅速改变，因为越来越多的研究者正试图了解这种优雅巨兽在其原生栖息地中的生物学特征和复杂行为。”	这题很多学生会卡在 has increased lately 这个说法上，担心原文没有直接出现“increase”这个词。其实原文是用同义改写表达的：先说 until recently almost nobody studied giraffes in the wild（直到最近几乎没人研究），接着马上说 All that is changing fast（这种情况正在迅速改变），并补充 a growing number of researchers（越来越多的研究者）。“越来越多的研究者”就等于“研究数量增加了”。所以题干和原文是一致的，选 TRUE。这题不能选 NG，因为文中不但提到了“以前少”，还明确提到了“现在在快速变化、研究者数量增长”，信息已经足够完整。
2	NOT GIVEN	Megan Strauss 不赞成长颈鹿被养在动物园里。	第1段：“Despite being a favorite in zoos, until recently almost nobody studied giraffes in the wild.” / “When I first became interested in giraffes in 2008 ... I was really surprised to see how little had been done,” said Megan Strauss ...”	“尽管长颈鹿在动物园里很受欢迎，但直到最近，几乎没有人研究野外的长颈鹿。” / “Megan Strauss 说：‘当我在2008年第一次对长颈鹿产生兴趣.....我非常惊讶地发现，相关研究做得这么少。’”	文中提到了长颈鹿在动物园里很受欢迎，也提到了 Megan Strauss 对“野外研究太少”感到惊讶，但没有说她是否反对把长颈鹿养在动物园里。disapprove of 是“不同意/不赞成”，这是态度判断题。原文没有给出她对动物园饲养长颈鹿的明确态度，所以是 NOT GIVEN。注意：提到动物园 ≠ 表达反对动物园。
3	FALSE	非洲的长颈鹿数量几乎翻倍了。	第2段：“The giraffe is listed as endangered, but researchers point to evidence that in the past 15 years, the population has fallen some 40 percent.”	“长颈鹿被列为濒危物种，但研究人员指出，有证据表明，在过去15年里，其数量下降了大约40%。”	题干说“几乎翻倍了”，意思是数量大幅上升；原文却说 fallen some 40 percent，即“下降了约40%”。方向完全相反，因此是 FALSE。
4	NOT GIVEN	雌性长颈鹿往往比雄性活得更久。	第3段：“Female giraffes can live 20 years or more ...”	“雌性长颈鹿可以活20年甚至更久.....”	原文只告诉我们雌性可以活20多年，但没有给出雄性的寿命，因此无法比较“雌性是否比雄性更长寿”。只给出一方的信息、不提供另一方，就不能比较，选 NOT GIVEN。
5	TRUE	母长颈鹿有时会用腿来保护幼崽。	第4段：“Giraffe calves are extremely vulnerable to predators, and though mothers will fight valiantly to keep their young alive — kicking forward and backward — ...”	“长颈鹿幼崽极易受到捕食者攻击，尽管母亲会勇敢地战斗来保护幼崽存活——向前、向后踢.....”	题干中的 use their legs to defend their young 对应原文中的 kicking forward and backward。kick 本身就是“用腿踢”，所以题干是原文的直接改写，选 TRUE。
6	FALSE	年轻的雄性长颈鹿在更强壮雄性面前会把脖子抬得更高。	第5段：“Recent observations show young bulls, when left on their own, mimicking their elders: head held high and neck puffed out. But should a dominant older bull come into view, the younger males instantly try to make themselves look small and innocent.”	“最近的观察表明，年轻雄性长颈鹿在独处时会模仿长者：抬高头部，鼓起脖子。但一旦占主导地位的年长雄性进入视野，年轻雄性就会立刻试图让自己看起来更小、更无害。”	题干说年轻雄性在强势雄性面前会把脖子抬得更高；原文恰好相反：只有在自己单独待着时，它们才会摆出高昂姿态；一旦强势老雄性出现，它们会让自己显得更小、更无害。所以是 FALSE。
7	TRUE	人们曾观察到雄性长颈鹿打斗。	第6段：“Clashes have been witnessed between adults when each bull repeatedly ‘necks’ the other, using his massive neck to slam his head against his rival.”	“人们曾目睹成年雄性之间发生冲突：每头公长颈鹿都会反复‘甩颈’攻击对方，用自己巨大的脖子把头猛撞向对手。”	题干中的 have been observed fighting 对应原文中的 Clashes have been witnessed between adults。clashes = fights/打斗，因此是 TRUE。

Q1 解释补充：

第1题选 TRUE。很多同学会被 until recently 卡住，以为它的意思是“直到现在都很少”。但 until recently 实际上是“直到最近之前”，也就是强调过去一直如此，最近开始发生变化。原文意思是：在最近之前，几乎没人研究野外长颈鹿；紧接着下一句又说 All that is changing fast，并且有 a growing number of researchers，意思是“这一情况正在迅速改变，而且研究者越来越多”。所以题干里的 has increased lately 正好对应这层意思：最近研究数量增加了。这里 lately 不是和 until recently 冲突，而是和后面的 is changing fast / a growing number 对应。若原文真想表达“直到现在研究仍然很少”，通常会说 there is still very little research 之类的话，但这篇文章明显不是这个意思，而是在强调“以前少，最近开始增多”。

Questions 8–13 Summary Table

题号	答案	题干翻译	详细定位句	定位句翻译	详细解释
8	camouflage	皮肤/皮毛：当站在树旁时，提供_____。	第7段：“ <i>The coat has dark patches separated by light hair, which serves as camouflage, allowing them to blend in with the light and shade patterns of the acacia trees from which they feed.</i> ”	“它们的皮毛上有深色斑块，中间夹着浅色毛发，这起到了伪装作用，使它们能够融入它们取食的金合欢树的光影图案中。”	空格前是 provides ，后面说“when standing near trees”，对应的是长颈鹿靠近树木时借助毛皮颜色融入环境，也就是 camouflage (伪装)。这是原词重现。
9	hands	嘴：可以像_____一样用来获取树叶。	第8段：“ <i>... a giraffe's extraordinary mouth has lips and tongue that can together grasp a branch and then pluck away the leaves while avoiding thorns, almost as humans would grab with their hands.</i> ”	“此外，长颈鹿非凡的嘴部拥有嘴唇和舌头，它们可以一起抓住树枝，然后在避开刺的同时摘下叶子，就像人类用手抓取一样。”	题干说“can be used like ____ to get leaves”，对应原文 almost as humans would grab with their hands 。所以答案是 hands 。注意不能写 human hands，因为题目要求 ONE WORD ONLY 。
10	birth	脖子：其长度在童年时期发育，以便母亲更容易_____。	第9段：“ <i>The growth of the neck largely takes place during early childhood, as giraffe mothers would have a difficult time giving birth to young with longer necks.</i> ”	“长颈鹿脖子的生长主要发生在幼年时期，因为如果幼崽天生脖子更长，母长颈鹿将难以分娩。”	题干里的 to provide an easier ____ for mothers 是对原文 would have a difficult time giving birth 的改写。这里名词应填 birth 。很多学生会想写 giving birth，但超过一个词，不行。
11	veins	心血管系统：特别强壮的_____防止血液溢入其他组织。	第10段：“ <i>The outside of a giraffe's veins are extremely thick, to prevent blood leaking into surrounding tissue.</i> ”	“长颈鹿静脉的外壁极其厚实，以防止血液渗漏到周围组织中。”	题干中 extra-strong 对应原文 extremely thick ； keep blood from spilling into other tissues 对应 prevent blood leaking into surrounding tissue 。主语是 veins ，所以答案填 veins 。
12	heart	_____：对于这样大的动物来说，大小正常。	第11段：“ <i>Researchers were also surprised to find that a giraffe does not have an unusually large heart. It is half a percent of body mass, the same as in a mouse.</i> ”	“研究人员还惊讶地发现，长颈鹿并没有异常大的心脏。它只占体重的0.5%，与老鼠相同。”	表格左边这一行是在填一个身体部位，而右边写的是“对于如此大的动物来说大小正常”。原文说长颈鹿没有 unusually large heart ，也就是心脏并不异常大，换句话说大小算正常，所以填 heart 。
13	signals	神经：反应更慢，因为_____需要走更远才能到达大脑。	第11段：“ <i>This is because signals from the nerves travel at about the same speed in giraffes as in rats or other mammals. Given the greater distance they have to travel in the giraffe to reach the brain ...</i> ”	“这是因为来自神经的信号在长颈鹿体内传播的速度，与在老鼠或其他哺乳动物体内大致相同。考虑到在长颈鹿体内它们必须传播更远的距离才能到达大脑……”	题干说“because ____ need to go farther to the brain”，这里真正“需要走更远”的不是 nerves 本身，而是 signals 。原文是 signals from the nerves travel... ，所以答案填 signals 。这题容易误填 nerves，但那样不符合句意。